

and what kind of chord voicings you're employing. This is another way to talk about arrangement.

When considering the arrangement, the first thing to do is try to identify the one or two aspects of the song that are the most significant, as well as the aspects that you want the audience to concentrate on. After that, give the track another listen and think to yourself, "What else might I do here to vary it up?" Does it require anything extra to be done? There are situations in which doing nothing is the best course of action. Knowing when to do something like this is what separates good producers from great ones.

Tracking

Now it's time to bring in the equipment. We'll refer to this step as "tracking" for the time being because the recording process can relate to so many different things; the purpose of this stage is to record a performance of the song.



There is a tune floating around in the ether. It's nothing more than a collection of random musical ideas. The recording of that music at a certain moment in time is what gives it a sense of tangibility. Playing a song live would make it more communicative, but it wouldn't make the song more tangible because it would vanish after the performance was finished. It is the recording that preserves the song in a manner that enables it to be played back repeatedly at the listener's discretion.